

1 Introduction to Windows 7



The all new Windows 7 interface with Flip 3D

All factors considered, Microsoft has the beginnings of a solid, streamlined, higher performing operating system with Windows 7 receiving a warmer reception as compared to Vista. When it comes to look and feel, the new UI of Windows 7 is the biggest step forward since Windows 95. It even makes the vintage-XP design look downright primitive. Under the hood, Windows 7 is a lot like Vista, sharing the same kernel architecture. Many consider Windows 7 to be just a cosmetic upgrade, a more polished version of Vista with little to offer beyond the new wallpaper and improved Aero experience. They couldn't have been more wrong. Windows 7 brings with it many new and enhanced features and improvements, which taken together deliver improved performance and productivity, better troubleshooting, a richer gaming experience, stronger security, a new approach towards compatibility with Windows XP mode and a whole lot more.

Windows 7 feels quick and responsive. It's a solid performer even on hardware originally designed for Windows XP, and we've found that it uses significantly less memory, disk space, and CPU cycles than Vista. There is a Resource Monitor, which allows you to perform some serious real-time sleuthing into running programs, services, and processes to see which ones are affecting performance or making unexpected network connections.